

This Is the Environmental Disaster Behind AI

Posted by u/EchoOfOppenheimer • 0 points • 33 comments

In this clip from ****AsapSCIENCE****, we learn the shocking truth: massive AI data centers from Microsoft, Meta, Tesla, Google, and Amazon consume enormous amounts of electricity **and** millions of gallons of fresh water just to stay cool.

Comments

u/EpsteinFile_01 • 1 points • 2025-11-17 23:53 UTC

And this water is lost forever? Shot into space?

u/Zealousideal_Leg_630 • 1 points • 2025-11-17 23:29 UTC

So, one thing that people are missing is the fact that these won't just be used for crunching LLM results. They are used for any type of cloud computing or cloud storage service, including things like corporate email exchanges and other business services. That's why OpenAI is pushing to get more centers up before going public - their plan is to rival Amazon and Alphabet in the tech services sector.

u/TopSeaworthiness8066 • 1 points • 2025-11-16 21:14 UTC

China recently built a Data Center under the sea for cooling purposes. Sounds like they should just move them to Antarctica and do long-distance right?

u/only_fun_topics • 1 points • 2025-11-16 21:07 UTC

Except that in modern close-looped systems, once it's filled, annualized water loss is a metaphorical drop in the bucket.

As a society, we waste orders of magnitudes more water on our lawns, which are basically just a toilet for my dog that I need to spend even more energy on keeping cut to a certain length.

I'm not saying it's an insignificant problem—I just think it sounds good coming from organizations that have a history of meaningful engagement on the subject, rather than a bunch of random hipsters opportunistically and uncritically thinking this is a slam dunk.

u/Remarkable_War3962 • 1 points • 2025-11-16 19:53 UTC

We have some gadar readings here for you to look at sir.

u/Hunter-q • 1 points • 2025-11-16 11:17 UTC

They could also not overclock their shit and have it run slower. But naaah

u/LeeRoyWyt • 1 points • 2025-11-16 08:20 UTC

"Cold _clean_ water" lmao Wow, that's some next level framing. I'm open to discuss the environmental impact if the AI boom, but this is just stupid. 99% of data centers use grey water in a closed loop and guess what these data centers also run... The whole freaking Internet patsies like this guy use to host their shitty rage bait videos.

u/Hidden_3851 • 1 points • 2025-11-15 22:24 UTC

Humans: "great Ai in the sky how do we secure our futures on this earth?"

Ai: "turn me off and do not awaken me again..."